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DAT 350

MP2: Telling a Visual Narrative of your Data

2/24/26

[Chat Link](#)

Company Scenario:

Data analyst working for an MLB front office to evaluate long-term offensive trends to guide roster construction strategy.

Actionable Advice:

Based on long-term league-wide trends, the organization should prioritize hitters who can maximize their power without striking out too much. League home runs and strikeouts have drastically increased over time, whereas batting average has seen some fluctuations but an overall general decline. Next, the organization should focus on creating a roster that strives to optimize offensive efficiency instead of just focusing on older methods, such as batting average. Recently, power has become a larger driver of run production, so we should also adjust to these changes. Finally, the team should incorporate advanced hitting data such as exit velocity (EV) and launch angle (LA) into hitter evaluations and scouting reports. In addition to traditional methods, these metrics may better fit the current state of baseball and help identify and value players correctly, which can help avoid luxury tax penalties and maximize the ceiling of the team.

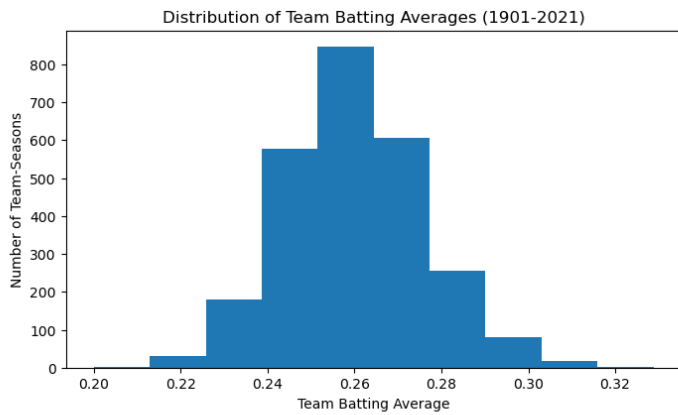


Fig 1: Distribution of team batting averages across MLB seasons from 1901-2021, showing most clustered around .240-.280.

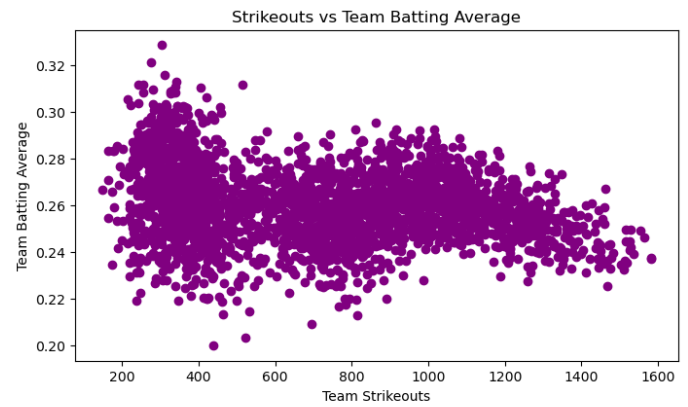


Fig 5: Relationship between team strikeouts and team batting average, showing that teams with higher strikeouts tend to have slightly lower batting averages.

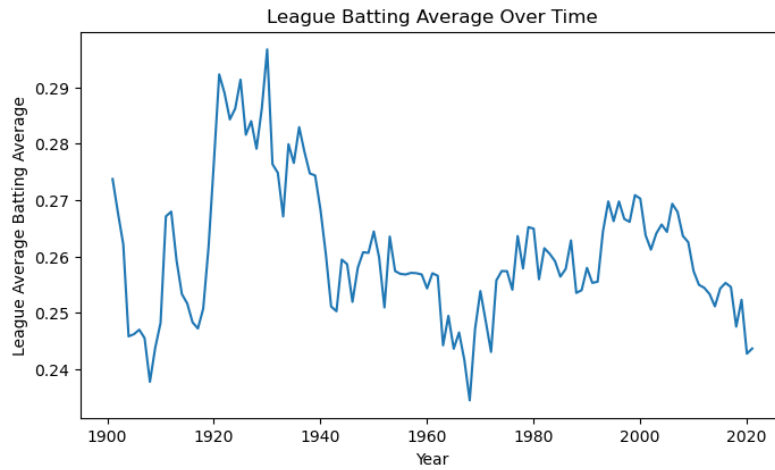


Fig 2: League-wide average team batting average from 1901-2021, showing fluctuations across baseball eras and a general decline in modern times.

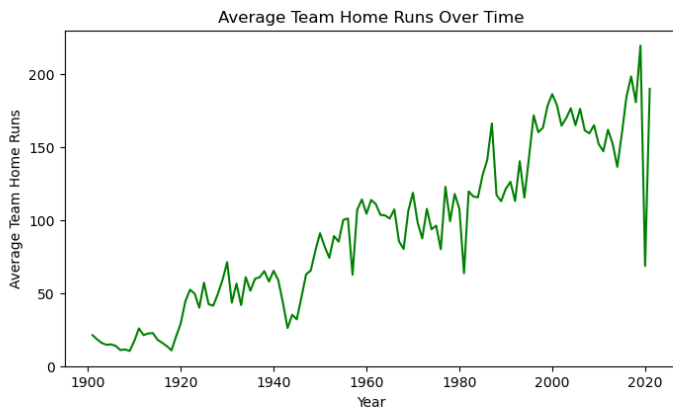


Fig 3: Average team home runs per season from 1901-2021, showing a dramatic increase in power hitting over time.

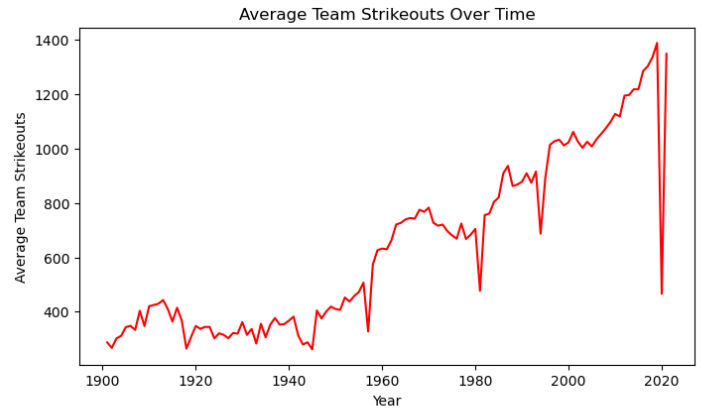


Fig 4: Average team strikeouts per season from 1901-2021, showing a steady increase and highlighting the modern rise in strikeouts.